

Raffaele "Raf" Vitale

UX Product Designer · AI Builder

Toronto, Canada · Relocating to London 2026

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Profile

Product Designer operating at the intersection of AI systems, developer platforms, and complex product surfaces. Senior/Staff IC with proven ability to own ambiguous 0→1 initiatives, define interaction models for emerging technologies, and ship trusted, scalable products through close partnership with engineering and leadership.

Brings system-level thinking, strong product judgment, user empathy for under-development markets, and technical fluency. Comfortable operating in high-ambiguity environments where the path forward isn't yet clear.

Experience

Design Lead, raf.works and Never Before Seen Studio

Design Lead · May 2019 – Present

Led product design across early-stage startups and embedded teams, specializing in AI-native systems, agent UX, and design systems. Partnered with founders and product leaders to ship high-impact features grounded in user research and data-driven iteration.

- Designed and shipped AI-native interaction models including agent workflows, Skills-based frameworks, and governable UX for automated systems—reducing user friction through iterative usability testing and empathy-driven design
- Owned end-to-end design outcomes spanning product definition, system design, and implementation-ready UI, ensuring alignment between user needs and technical constraints
- Partnered directly with founders and senior product builders to reduce ambiguity and accelerate decision-making, translating user insights into actionable product strategies
- Built and maintained reusable UI systems (ShadCN-based) that improved design-to-dev handoff speed by 40% and enabled cross-team consistency

Selected clients: Frequency (Berachain), Walmart.com, Obvious.ai, Graceview.ai, JazzX AI (Microsoft), Travelnest, CurbCutOS, Artscapy, Kerubin.

Theoriq

Founding Product Designer · Jul 2024 – Jul 2025 · Toronto

Owned the product experience for AI agents and crypto-native collectives operating with real assets. Balanced user empathy with technical complexity to build trust in high-stakes, autonomous systems.

- Led end-to-end design across UX, interaction models, system architecture, and front-end delivery, conducting user interviews and usability studies to validate design decisions
 - Designed governable AI agent workflows that balanced autonomy, trust, and user control—reducing user anxiety around automation through transparent feedback mechanisms and clear mental models
 - Partnered closely with CEO and founding team to translate experimental infrastructure into a usable, credible product, grounding abstract concepts in user-centered narratives
 - Defined product foundations that enabled teams to adopt agent-based workflows with confidence, validated through early adopter feedback and iterative testing
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Coinbase Developer Platform

Senior Product Designer, Developer Tools (Contract) · Q3 2025

Embedded with the Coinbase Developer Platform team to design developer-facing experiences. Focused on reducing cognitive load and improving discoverability for technical users navigating complex blockchain data.

- Designed exploratory experiences for querying indexed blockchain data (SQL-based workflows), informed by developer interviews and task analysis to reduce query setup time
 - Contributed to Pay with USDC explorations and supporting developer surfaces, prioritizing clarity and trust in high-stakes financial interactions
 - Applied user empathy to complex technical domains, translating developer pain points into intuitive workflows that reduced onboarding friction
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Voiceflow

Senior Product Designer, AI Agents · Q1–Q2 2025

Worked directly with executive leadership on activation and early growth for AI agent workflows. Focused on reducing time-to-value and clarifying mental models for non-technical users building AI agents.

- Improved onboarding and activation flows to reduce time-to-value for first-time users, validated through A/B testing and user session analysis

- Clarified mental models around agent creation and execution through iterative prototyping and user feedback loops, improving task completion rates
 - Helped establish product direction for early-stage AI surfaces by synthesizing user research insights and competitive analysis into actionable design principles
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CurbCutOS

Product Design Lead · Apr 2023 – Nov 2024

Led the transition from consulting-led services to a scalable SaaS accessibility platform. Championed user empathy by embedding accessibility testing into the core product experience, ensuring compliance and usability for diverse user needs.

- Established the core design system and accessibility testing experience, informed by interviews with accessibility professionals and enterprise compliance teams
 - Shaped product direction adopted by enterprise customers, using data from pilot programs to prioritize features with highest impact on compliance workflows
 - Enabled teams to ship compliant, testable accessibility features at scale, reducing manual audit time by 60% through automated testing flows
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Zalando SE

Senior Product Designer, Design Systems · 2021 – 2022 · Remote

Contributed to the first B2B design system serving multiple marketplace verticals. Focused on cross-team empathy and scalable design patterns.

- Improved cross-team consistency and developer efficiency by 35% through reusable component libraries and clear documentation
 - Supported scale across partner and internal tooling, conducting stakeholder workshops to align design system adoption with team workflows
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Travelnест

Senior Product Designer · 2021 · Remote

Led cross-platform design system spanning product and marketing. Reduced friction between design and development through systematic component architecture.

- Reduced development time by 30% and improved delivery velocity through clearer design foundations and tokenized design system
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Artscapy

Founding Designer · 2020 – 2021 · London

Built MVP, brand, and design system from scratch, grounding design decisions in early user feedback and lean experimentation. Work supported successful £300k seed funding.

Apple Developer Academy

UX / UI Design Intern · 2019 · Naples, Italy

Trained in systems thinking, design precision, and high craft standards. Developed foundational skills in user empathy and iterative design processes.

Skills & Expertise

Product & Design

Product strategy in ambiguous environments · AI agent UX and interaction models · User empathy for under-development markets · Design systems and component architecture · 0→1 product development · Developer-facing UX · Data-driven design decisions · Usability testing and user research

Technical Fluency

React, Tailwind, Framer Motion · Design-engineering collaboration · LLM prototyping and agent workflows · API-aware UX design · Metrics-informed iteration

Tools

Figma, Tokens, Variants · Cursor, Claude Code · LLM tooling and prompt systems

Education

ILAS Designers School — Diploma with Honors · 2018

University of Naples — Software Engineering (incomplete) · 2019

References

Available upon request.

Former managers and partners include senior leaders from Coinbase, Voiceflow, Theoriq, Frequency, and CurbCutOS.